Northeastern University
Khoury College of
Computer Sciences

CS1210: Professional Development for Khoury Co-op|Fall 2020

Course Description

This course is designed to launch your co-op search and give you an understanding of the co-op process, policies, and expectations of the Co-op Department. You will prepare a professional resume; learn interviewing techniques; and develop a methodical approach to identifying jobs that align with your goals, values, interests, personality, skills, and experience. The course will cover concepts of professional and ethical behavior in the workplace, getting the most out of your co-op experience, and achieving professional success.

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Teaching Assistants

This course will have an experienced Teaching Assistant. TA's for CS1210 are Khoury students, who have completed at least one co-op experience. TA(s) will serve as a resource for students throughout this course. They will offer their perspective on course concepts, serve as mentors to students during co-op search, and assist with course facilitation.

Teaching Assistant: Colton Donnelly
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Office Hours

During the first week of the course, a class announcement will be sent detailing office hours and how-to sign-up to meet with me or the TA(s).

Prerequisites

Prior to searching for a co-op, you should have successfully completed first-year classes (CS1800/01, CS2500/01, CS2510/11) with a passing grade. Additionally, to begin your co-op search, you must have completed, or be enrolled in, the following courses as it applies to your respective program of study:

- Computer Science (CS) and CS combined majors: **Object Oriented Design** (CS3500)
- Data Science (DS) and DS combined majors: **Foundations of Data Science** (DS3000)
- Cybersecurity (CY) and CY combined majors: **Computer Systems** (CS3650)

If you fail or withdraw from one of these courses during co-op search, you will lose co-op eligibility. Should you choose to appeal your co-op eligibility status, speak with your Co-op Advisor to learn about the appeals process.

Learning Outcomes

This course will provide you with the information and skills necessary to conduct a successful co-op search and achieve professional success in the workplace. After successfully completing this course, you should be able to:

- Describe co-op policies, procedures, and expectations of the Co-op Department
- Write a professional resume and cover letter

- Demonstrate understanding of effective interviewing techniques, professional communication etiquette, and networking with employers
- Develop an effective job search plan by applying job search fundamentals and evaluating job opportunities based on values, interests, personality, and skills
- Demonstrate professional and ethical behavior in the workplace
- Recognize the value of interpreting challenges, successes, and failures from a growth perspective and understand the importance of reflecting on experiences
- Identify how diversity and inclusion applies in the workplace and develop an appreciation for working in diverse teams

Textbooks and Course Materials

There is no textbook for this course. The course content will include videos, articles, and self-paced modules.

Technology Requirements

To access course materials and watch videos, you will need a reliable high-speed internet connection and a computer equipped with basic audio/ video equipment, including microphone and webcam.

Course Structure

This is an asynchronous online course accessible through Canvas. The course content will be provided through prerecorded lectures, self-paced modules, and readings. You will be able to access the course content and participate in class discussions within a flexible time frame, thereby allowing you to create your own learning schedule each week. You will be responsible for submitting assignments by the assigned deadlines.

Course Schedule

Week	Class	Description	SAIL Dimensions
Week 1 9/14 - 9/20	Introduction to Co-op	Offers an overview of the course, policies, and co-op eligibility. Sets expectations for participation in the course and co-op search.	• Intellectual Agility • Personal and Professional Effectiveness
Week 2 9/21 – 9/27	Marketing Yourself to Employers	Offers an overview of the overall co-op process. Provides an overview of what employers are looking for when hiring for a job, how to use a resume to build a competitive advantage in the job market, and how to market effectively to employers using a resume.	• Personal and Professional Effectiveness • Intellectual Agility • Social Consciousness and Commitment
Week 3 9/28 – 10/4	Job Search and Career Pathways	Covers fundamentals of creating an effective job search plan, including job selection, assessing a job description for fit, leveraging transferrable skills, and writing a winning cover letter. You will learn about different career tracks and co-op positions that Khoury students typically pursue.	• Intellectual Agility • Personal and Professional Effectiveness

Week 4 10/5 – 10/11	Interviewing and Employer Communication	Develop and identify effective interviewing and professional communication etiquette.	• Intellectual Agility • Professional and Personal Effectiveness
Week 5 10/12 – 10/18	Student Panel	Provides an opportunity to engage with and hear from a panel of Khoury students who have completed at least one co-op experience.	• Well-Being • Social Consciousness and Commitment • Intellectual Agility • Professional and Personal Effectiveness
Week 6 10/19 – 10/25	Building Your LinkedIn Profile	Develop an understanding and appreciation for LinkedIn as a tool for building professional network while establishing a personal brand and robust profile.	• Professional and Personal Effectiveness • Intellectual Agility
Week 7 10/26 – 11/01	Expanding Your Search Through Networking	Leverage LinkedIn to network and land a co-op opportunity. Establish connections and learn how to reach out for getting information about companies and jobs of interest. Master virtual networking to support co-op search.	• Professional and Personal Effectiveness • Intellectual Agility
Week 8 11/02 – 11/08	TA-Led Workshops	Based on personal interests and need, attend at least one TA-led workshop designed to answer your questions and develop skills to support your co-op search.	• Personal and Professional Effectiveness • Well-Being • Intellectual Agility
Reflection Week: 11/9 -11/15 *Use this time to reflect on your co-op search and what you have learned so far in this course. You are encouraged to connect with your Co-op Advisor to discuss your co-op search progress. TA(s) and Instructor will be available to answer your questions related to the course. You are encouraged to use this week to practice interviews.*			
Week 9 11/16 – 11/22	Navigating Workplace Challenges	Learn what it means to be a professional in remote and in-person work settings and how to deal with challenges that may arise at work.	• Personal and Professional Effectiveness • Global Mindset • Well-Being
Thanksgiving Break: 11/23 – 11/29			
Week 10 11/30 – 12/06	Optimizing Your Co-op Experience	Offers tips to successfully complete a co-op experience and maximize learning. Provides you with an opportunity to reflect on your personal and professional growth experienced through co-op search.	• Personal and Professional Effectiveness • Well-Being

Assignments			
*All assignments are due at **11:59 pm US Eastern Standard Time** on the day specified in the table.*			
Week	**Due Date**	**Assignments**	**Points**
Prep Work	Sunday, 9/13	• Watch Resume Module • Create resume draft	3 2
Week 1 9/14 - 9/20	Wednesday, 9/16 Sunday, 9/20 Sunday, 9/20	• Getting to Know You ➢ Primary Post ➢ Secondary Post • SAIL Moment	3 3
Week 2 9/21 - 9/27	Sunday, 9/27	• Group Assignment- Employer for a Day (Part 1) • Individual Response-Employer for a Day (Part 2)	7 3
Week 3 9/28 - 10/4	Sunday, 10/4	• Job Search Takeaways • Career Pathways Takeaways	3 3
Week 4 10/05 - 10/11	Wednesday, 10/7 Wednesday, 10/7 Wednesday, 10/7 Sunday, 10/11	• Module: Ace the Interview • Peer Interviewing Assignment • Discussion Board: Employer Email Communication ➢ Primary Post ➢ Secondary Post	5 5 5
Week 5 10/12 - 10/18	Sunday, 10/18	• Student Panel Reflection Assignment • Mid-Semester SAIL Moment	3 3
Week 6 10/19 - 10/25	Sunday, 10/25	• Build Your LinkedIn Profile	5
Week 7 10/26 - 11/01	Sunday, 11/01	• LinkedIn-Networking Connections (Part 1) • LinkedIn-Identifying Alumni (Part 2) • LinkedIn-Reaching out (Part 3)	3 3 6
Week 8 11/02 - 11/08	Sunday, 11/08	• Workshop Reflection	6
Week 9 *11/15-11/22*	Sunday, 11/22	• Module: Professional and Personal Effectiveness in the Workplace • Employer Scenario Group Assignment and Individual Reflection • Events*	5 3 6

Week 10 11/29– 12/06	Sunday, 12/6 Wednesday, 12/2 Sunday, 12/6 Sunday, 12/6 Sunday, 12/6	• Module-While on Co-op • Discussion Board: Personal Reflection and Advice ➢ Primary Post ➢ Secondary Post • Final SAIL Moment • Course Evaluation	5 3 3 1
		Total Points:	100
*Plan to attend events early in the semester and don't wait until you are close to the due date to attend events for completing this assignment.			

Grading

Assignments: 94%

Assignments are due as specified in the assignments table (see pages 7 and 8). Note that all assignment deadlines are as per **US Eastern Standard Time**. All submissions after the deadline will be considered late. You can earn up to **half credit for a late assignment if turned in by 12:00pm of the next day after the due date.** Any assignment submitted after that will receive zero credit.

Events: 6%

In order to prepare you for co-op search and help you build professional skills, you will be required to attend at least two co-op related events and complete the Events Assignment in Canvas by **November 22, 2020.** You may choose events hosted by Khoury College, Northeastern University, or off-campus events that you think can help you with your co-op search and professional goals. These events can include employer information sessions, student organization events, employer tech talks, technical interview practice sessions, networking events, and more. You are encouraged to choose events that support your area of interest and co-op search needs.

Grading Scale:

There is a strong relationship between performance in this course and success on the job. Success in this class ensures that you bring your best self to employers throughout the job application and interview process. For that reason, success for this course is a **grade of D- or higher**. *Anything below a D- indicates that you are not prepared for a co-op experience, will receive a failing grade, and must retake this course*. By failing this course, you will lose co-op eligibility. Should you choose to appeal your co-op eligibility status, you can speak with your Co-op Advisor to learn about the appeals process.

There is a total of 100 points for the class. The final letter grade will be based on the following grading criterion:

A 93 and above	C- 70 – 72
A- 90 – 92	D+ 67 – 69
B+ 87 – 89	D 63 – 66
B 83 – 86	D- 60 – 62
B- 80 – 82	F 59 and below
C+ 77-79	
C 73 – 76	

Defining and Achieving Success

Our employer partners are counting on us to coach and prepare you for a successful transition from classroom to professional setting. Success in this course is a strong indicator of your future professional success.

Success markers in this course include, but are not limited to:

- Comprehensive review of weekly learning modules (i.e. watch the video modules, complete the readings, and submit assignments each week)
- Strong understanding of the course concepts
- Well thought out assignments submitted on time
- Active participation in discussion boards

Characteristics of Successful Learners?

- **It's okay to be wrong!** Not all our answers or actions are perfect every time. Many times, we head down the wrong path. Reflecting regularly on your experiences allows you to grow. Sometimes what you think is a mistaken path might be an alternative approach to solving a problem. Never hold yourself back out of fear that you might be wrong! Consider this course to be an online learning space that is free of judgment and no question is considered trivial.
- **It's okay to ask for help!** There is no smartest job candidate. We can all collaborate with each other to come up with strong responses for an interview or a more integrative solution to a technical interview question. The challenges you experience are a learning opportunity so do not ever hesitate to seek help from the teaching team. The more questions you ask, the better prepared you will be for job search and to work in a professional environment. Remember asking for help is a sign of strength and not weakness.
- **Active Participation:** This course focuses on interactive and collaborative learning. Your success in this course is hugely dependent on the level of your participation which includes successful completion of weekly learning modules, active participation on discussion boards, collaboration with peers and teaching team, and attending office hours. Your Instructor and TA(s) will act as the facilitators and play an active role in monitoring your interaction and offering constructive feedback.

Policies and Expectations

Professional Etiquette:

The purpose of this course is to prepare you for professional success. To achieve that goal, I expect you to behave in this course as you would in a professional environment. This means treating me, your TA(s), and your classmates with respect.

Communication:

When communicating online with your classmates or teaching team, avoid spelling errors, emoticons, slang terms, or abbreviations such as "u" instead of "you", using all caps e.g. I NEED HELP, PLEASE HELP ME, etc. for emphasis. Message written with all caps may be interpreted as yelling. For discussion board assignments, if you disagree with a classmate's point of view, be polite in your posts. Your communication in this course should be as if you were communicating in a professional setting.

Note: *Online bullying, condescending or insulting comments, racial slurs, discriminatory behavior, and offensive remarks are not acceptable and may be reported to the Office of Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution. Lastly, be cautious when using humor or sarcasm as your intent might be misinterpreted in an online setting.*

Academic Integrity:
This course does not lend itself to academic dishonesty because it asks you to create or to reflect on your own experience. Northeastern University views academic dishonesty as one of the most serious offenses that a student can commit while in college and imposes appropriate punitive sanctions. Dishonesty in the class will be dealt with according to the policies of Academic Dishonesty at Northeastern University. Listed below are some examples of academic dishonesty:

> *Cheating* – intentionally using or attempting to use unauthorized materials, information or study aids in an academic exercise.
>
> *Fabrication* –intentional and unauthorized falsification, misrepresentation, or invention of any data, or citation in an academic exercise.
>
> *Plagiarism* – intentionally representing the words, ideas, or data of another as one's own in any academic exercise without providing proper citation.

For more information on **Academic Integrity**, click here.

Collaboration:
During the semester, you will work on several group assignments. I expect each group member to engage and contribute equally and meet the expectations of their group. If a group member does not contribute their fair share of work for an assignment and tries to solely rely on the efforts of other members, I will consider that a violation of the collaborative guidelines for this course. If you violate the collaboration guidelines, you may lose points for the assignment and may be reported to the *Office of Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution*. Examples of violation include, but are not limited to:

- Simply copying other group members' work without putting in the effort or time on the assignment
- Taking unfair credit for work done by others in the group
- Having another group member complete your portion of the group assignment
- Not putting in the work or taking responsibility for your assigned share of work
- Lying about the level of your participation or misrepresenting your role in the group assignment

Note: *While working on group assignments, if you find a group member in violation of these collaboration guidelines, feel free to reach out to me.*

Diversity and Inclusion:
Northeastern University deeply values diversity and inclusion. I want this class to be a place where everyone feels welcomed, valued, and appreciated regardless of their ethnicity, race, gender, sexual orientation, national origin, mental and physical ability, religion, etc. As an Instructor, one of my core beliefs is that every student brings unique experiences, strengths, and ideas to this course and that diverse perspectives in a learning space enhance the quality of learning experience for everyone. Your ability to work well with a diverse group of peers will translate into your ability to collaborate and work well with colleagues with diverse backgrounds.

With that in mind, be sure to respect the diversity and diverse perspectives in this course. It's perfectly fine to disagree with someone's point of view, but disagreement should be expressed politely and gracefully. When working in groups, make an intentional effort to be inclusive of all group members. At any time, reach out to the me with any concerns about diversity, equity, and inclusion.

University Resources

Disability Resource Center: If you have a disability-related need for reasonable academic accommodations in this course and have not yet met with a Disability Specialist, visit http://www.northeastern.edu/drc/ and follow the outlined procedure to request services. If the Disability Resource Center has formally approved you for an academic accommodation in this class, submit the "**Professor Notification Letter**" to the Instructor.

Note: *If you have a disability related need, unique learning style, or a trait that has an impact on how you learn, speak with me to strategize ways to manage that. I want to ensure every student gets a valuable learning experience in this course. If English is your second language, let me know. I can share resources that might be helpful.*

University Health and Counseling Services (UHCS): To seek help with physical and mental health issues, contact UHCS. To learn more about their services, visit their website.

Employer Engagement and Career Design Office: This office offers career advising, workshops, employer events, and career development resources for students. Students can utilize their services by attending walk-in hours or scheduling one-on-one advising appointment with a Career Advisor. To learn more, visit their website.

Additional Resources: Click here to access a comprehensive list of **Academic and Student Resources** offered by Northeastern University.